

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Miss Jaine Schwarz

Address: 26 Brasted Close Sutton SM2 5BE

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I strongly object to the proposed development at the former Sutton Ambulance Station on Dorset Road. The scale, intensity, and nature of this proposal make it wholly inappropriate for its setting and would cause significant, lasting, and unacceptable harm to the surrounding residential community.

1. A fundamentally incompatible use in a 100% residential area

This is a quiet neighbourhood made up entirely of homes, flats, and gardens. Introducing a highcapacity place of worship and community hub-operating long hours, hosting highturnover events, and attracting large volumes of people-would radically and permanently disrupt the tranquillity of the area. This type of facility simply does not belong in such a location.

2. Visually overbearing and completely out of character

The proposed extensions and increased building height would create a structure that is visually dominant and entirely out of keeping with the domestic scale of neighbouring properties. It would erode the established look, feel, and rhythm of the neighbourhood and introduce a commercial scale presence in a suburban street.

3. No unmet need-this development is unjustified and excessive

Multiple similar facilities already exist within 1-1.5 miles of this site, including those used by the applicant. There is no shortfall in provision and no evidence to justify positioning a highintensity community centre in a suburban location with extremely poor public transport accessibility (PTAL 1a). This development is unnecessary, overconcentrated, and in the wrong place.

4. Serious noise and latenight disturbance

The Council's own report acknowledges that the proposal could result in raised noise and disturbance, including the dispersal of up to 250 people at 11pm. This level of activity is wholly unsuitable for a residential street and would severely undermine neighbours' ability to enjoy peace, privacy, and sleep. This is a direct threat to residential amenity.

5. Unacceptable parking pressure and traffic impact

The proposal relies heavily on onstreet parking, with demand expected to exceed onsite capacity and spill into surrounding roads. Combined with poor public transport links, this will cause congestion, reduce highway safety, and significantly inconvenience residents, particularly during peak event times.

6. Damaging cumulative impact on community character

Taken together, the increased noise, traffic, footfall, lateevening activity, and intense use would fundamentally alter the character of the neighbourhood. This development would replace a calm, suburban residential environment with a highintensity activity hub, harming the area's cohesion, identity, and quality of life.

Conclusion

This proposal is unnecessary, inappropriate, and harmful.

It threatens residential amenity, undermines the established suburban character of the area, and introduces a scale and intensity of use that the location simply cannot support.

For these reasons, I strongly urge the Council to refuse the proposed development.